DAY 24 OF 30

Knowing what you have

Governance in Fabric.
Lineage, labels and trust.

Catalog | Lineage | Endorsement

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THE PROBLEM

After a year, nobody knows which table to trust.

1	**sales_final**	Is this the real one?
2	**sales_final_v2**	Or this?
3	**Who owns it**	Left the company in March
4	**Contains personal data**	Nobody is sure

The platform works. **Finding and trusting the right data is the hard part.**

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THE SIMPLE VERSION

Labels and receipts on every box.

A warehouse without labels is just a room full of boxes. With labels, receipts and a floor plan, anyone can find what they need and know where it came from.

Governance gives your data **those labels, receipts and a floor plan.**

✓ **Catalog**	The floor plan
✓ **Lineage**	The receipt trail
✓ **Labels**	What is inside, and how sensitive

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HOW IT WORKS

The tools Fabric gives you

1. **OneLake catalog**: explore, govern and secure in one place
2. **Domains** group workspaces by business area
3. **Endorsement**: Promoted, Certified, Master data
4. **Sensitivity labels** follow the data downstream
5. **Lineage view** shows what feeds what

Purview underneath

Labels and protection policies come from Microsoft Purview, the same ones used across Microsoft 365.

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FOR ENGINEERS

Making it work in practice

Certify sparingly

If everything is Certified, the badge means nothing. Reserve it for data a named owner stands behind.

Lineage is per workspace

The lineage view covers one workspace. Cross-workspace flows need more deliberate tracking.

Labels inherit

A label on a lakehouse carries through to items built on it, which protects exports too.

Ownership before tooling

A catalog full of items with no owner is a tidy list of unanswered questions.

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THE HONEST PART

How much governance is enough?

START WITH	ADD LATER
A named owner for every Gold table	A committee for every change
Sensitivity labels on personal data	Detailed documentation of Bronze
Certification for core datasets	Approval steps nobody will follow

> **The catch:** governance that slows people down gets bypassed. The version that works is the lightest one people will actually follow.

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FROM REAL WORK

Governance on a real project

A manufacturing group with plants and business units in several countries.

1. **Data governance** was standardised across international units
2. **Access control** followed one model everywhere
3. **System architecture diagrams** documented the flows
4. **Audit-ready KPIs** went to top leadership

Across borders, **shared rules** mattered more than shared tools.

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SAVE THIS

Governance in five lines

1. **A catalog** so data can be found
2. **Owners** so questions have answers
3. **Endorsement** so people know what to trust
4. **Labels** so sensitive data stays protected
5. **Lineage** so changes do not surprise anyone

Tomorrow: Git and deployment pipelines. Shipping changes without breaking production.

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